

Loyalty Signaling in Hong Kong (1997–2026)

A Textual Analysis of Political Discourse — Deng, X., Liu, J., & Zhong, J.



Research Question

- **Loyalty Signaling:** more frequent reference to central authorities, remarks, ideology and policy directions in public discourse?
- **Mainlandization:** wholesale importation of Mainland-style rhetorical system?



Methodology

- **Dataset:** 6,994 press releases & 2,697 CE speeches across 5 terms
- **Framework:** six categories of loyalty signaling keywords
- **Analysis:** loyalty-signaling keyword density, cosine similarity

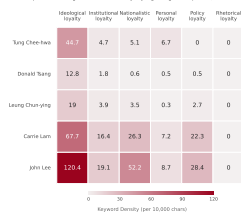


Key Findings

- **Cyclical Reparative Strategy:** Loyalty signaling as a reparative mechanism, acutely intensifying following socio-political friction
- **Pragmatic Approach:** Despite high density, semantic similarity with Mainland addresses remains low - insert keywords modularly rather than adopting structural Mainland “officialese”

Loyalty Keyword Density Across Chief Executive Tenures (1997-2026)

Values represent average occurrences of loyalty-signaling terms per 10,000 characters in CE speeches.



Full Report

